

Worship in Spirit Is a Positional Truth

Turn to John 4, where we left off. I am living in great hopes that we will make it beyond John 4 this time.

Hallelujah. Glory be to God.

We left off at the only verse we made it to, which was verse 23. Last week He had me major on the twenty-third and twenty-fourth verses of John 4. The point He wanted me to make was the positional truth of it.

The positional truth of worshiping Him in spirit and in truth is that the Old Testament saints could not do it. When Jesus said, "The hour cometh, and now is," He meant there had never been an hour like that since the fall of Adam and the spiritual inheritance of death the whole human race inherited from the first man, Adam.

There was no one since the fall of Adam who could worship Him in spirit, because Jesus was talking about a positional truth. He told the Samaritan woman, "This hour is here."

God spoke to me while breaking this down. Thank God for praying the mysteries out. Amen. The mystery is the understanding of everything Christ is in you, the hope of glory: in you, to you, and through you.

I thank God for the revelation gift of praying in tongues, because that is the basis for personal edification. It is a revelation gift.

Having prayed that mystery out on the Born-Again Trail, God suddenly dropped it into my spirit. When I got to this part of the trail, He said, "All you have to do is break down 'the hour cometh, and now is' on the millennial time clock."

One day is as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. So what is one hour on that clock? It breaks down to about forty-one years.

Then I understood that Jesus, talking to the Samaritan woman, was telling her, "This is the hour all creation has been waiting for. It has finally come, when I get creation back, at least the first phase of redemption and our inheritance."

He said, "The hour cometh." The Father seeketh such. He waited for this hour, when the true worshipers would once again be able to worship Him, which had not happened since Adam, in spirit out of a new nature, and in truth that can only come from that standing with God.

He said the Father seeketh such.

When He said, "The Father seeketh such to worship him," it did not mean He is hopping from church to church looking for a good worship team. It meant He waited out the dispensations of four thousand years for the first man to appear on this planet who had a nature free from sin.

He waited out the dispensations of four thousand years. As Paul described it, the promises, the covenants, and the adoption came through the fathers. He waited out all those dispensations. He sought such. He wanted this, and finally the first Man appeared who could give Him what He wanted.

Then you and I were quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places. I have been translated out of darkness into the kingdom of light and His dear Son.

When I was translated out of darkness, my spirit was spiritually dead and had a sin nature. Suddenly, by an act of grace, I stepped out of that and into the kingdom of His Son, the kingdom of light, with a new nature able to give my Father what He waited for through four thousand years of dispensation.

Hallelujah.

Thank God for the revelation gift of speaking those untold hours. He that prays in an unknown tongue speaks not unto men but unto God. In the spirit, this man is speaking mysteries. He is in his new nature, and the Holy Ghost is using it to pray through.

In the spirit, this man is speaking the mysteries of everything Christ is in you, to you, and through you: the hope of glory.

I love the times when you pray a mystery out and He comes and answers it. A minute before, you were ignorant, dumb, unlearned, and going somewhere to prove it. Suddenly a mystery goes off in your spirit. You understand something you have never understood before.

By the way, faith does come by hearing. Suddenly you are hearing by the Word in a way you have never heard before. The Holy Ghost is saying, "I was able to get this over to their spirit. They understand it now. But getting it over to that mind of theirs is another problem."

That is what happens when I stand up to teach. He can drop a whole mystery into my spirit in a matter of seconds. A moment before, I understood very little about that chapter or verse. Then, a second later, the whole thing opens up and drops inside the capacity you received when you were born again in that new nature.

The carnal mind is the enemy of God. That is a mind fed by spiritual death. But a person who is born again has the power to discern spiritual things. That means I can understand God by the nature He gave me, even past what my mind can understand.

You have had that happen. You just know, and you do not know how you know, but you know this is right. If someone asks you how to prove it, you cannot, but you just know.

Try teaching out of that place. Moments before, I did not know. Then suddenly the mystery goes off and I am understanding something I have never understood before. Something has cleared up.

That is the capacity of your human spirit. It has one tremendous capacity. You have the capacity to understand God.

One of the best ways to describe it is like a computer. You have a computer chip that can download an entire program in seconds. But the monitor is like your mind or brain. It can only hold one screen at a time. The whole program is in the reservoir, but it can only feed the mind one screen at a time.

That is the gifting of a teacher. A teacher is supposed to have a gift to pull revelation out in sequence so that, when he is done, you understand what he understands. That is supposed to be the gift of a teacher.

There is a two-way anointing with true teachers. You are not only anointed to flow and unfold God's mind; while it is unfolding, you are also supposed to discern where the crowd is. That is the standard equipping of a teacher. If you go beyond them, you can stop, pull back, and stay there until it clears up.

Some of you wonder why I hang around a subject for three months. It is not to clear it up for myself. I am not going to indict myself any further. After all, you are friends and family.

John probably knew more outside of any other man than the apostle Paul, and of course Jesus our Lord. John probably knew more about nature and about who we would become.

"What manner of love is this, that we should be called the sons and daughters of God?"

John obviously understood that love. God elected him to write things nobody else had written, much less understood.

But I can also tell in Paul's love for the Jew, and in his writings, that even when he was writing to Gentile churches, he would continually go back and demonstrate something under the law and something that we Gentiles got in on. Usually his description and revelation came based on the law, which he obviously understood more thoroughly than any man alive.

Paul came from that approach, but make no mistake: he understood as much about that new nature as any man alive.

It should not be surprising that when the Holy Ghost sees and supports your spirit and becomes your Teacher, He makes a beeline for God your Father and begins to reveal who He is and who Jesus is, from glory to glory.

Hallelujah. Thank You, Jesus.

Look again at John 4:23-24:

But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him.

God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.

If you have a good King James translation, the s in "spirit" is lowercase, and it is correct, because Jesus is speaking in reference to your human spirit. They will worship the Father in spirit and in truth.

Why? "For the Father seeketh such to worship him."

Then He tells you why: "God is a Spirit." Isn't that interesting? God is a Spirit. He has a nature like yours. He is love. He is your Father, and you are a spiritual being.

God is a Spirit, and they that worship Him must worship Him out of that place, that new nature by which you have become His sons and daughters.

He is a Spirit. He is your Father. And He comes seeking.

We need to go back, because He wanted me to review this a little before we take the next step. Even though we have explored a little of where we are going, we have not established it in you strongly enough that you cannot turn left, right, forward, or backward without understanding it. It is important to the next place He wants to bring you and me.

So let's go back and follow this Born-Again Trail up to John 4:23-24, and pick out the highlights one more time.

Go to John 1. Begin with the first verse. Since we have been over this probably more than anything else on the Born-Again Trail, you should be able to hang on as we go into high gear.

That spirit of yours is created in God's class. That is why He prefers to communicate with your spirit. He can download something, and when He does in me, sometimes it takes months to preach what He gave me in seconds. That is the capacity of your born-again human spirit.

John 1 says:

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

The same was in the beginning with God.

All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.

In the beginning, before anything had a beginning that we understand to exist, was the Word, the second Person in the Godhead. The Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was back there with God before anything we understand to have a beginning had a beginning.

All things were made by Him. Without Him, that second Person in the Godhead, the Word whom we now know and love as Jesus the God-man, nothing was made. The Greek puts a pigtail on that and says, "not one single thing."

Then John suddenly switches from His deity to His humanity in verse 4:

In him was life; and the life was the light of men.

If that life in Him became my light, what life and what light was He talking about? Verse 5 helps:

And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.

The darkness He was talking about is the spiritually dead state of the human race with the sin nature. All of a sudden, here is this planet, and on this planet every single person is spiritually dead. Then comes the Son of God, and in Him was life.

What was that life? He was the first Man to be born on this planet spiritually alive. In Him was life, and that life was soon to become my light.

That light shined in the dark state of the human race. Not one man was spiritually alive, but there was one single candle burning on this entire planet, and that was Jesus.

The light shined in darkness, and the darkness could not understand it. They did not comprehend it.

But the day came, the one He was talking about to the Samaritan woman, when you and I were quickened together with Him, translated out of that darkness into the kingdom of light and His dear Son. We received God's nature, and now our spirits burn with the same life He burned with before He sacrificed Himself and gave Himself for me.

I was resurrected with Him. Hallelujah, Jesus. I am alive. I have been born again.

We cannot leave Nicodemus out. Start with John 3:1:

There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews:

The same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God: for no man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him.

Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.

Nicodemus thought he had already seen it when he saw the miracles Jesus had done. But Jesus said, "No. Until you are born again, you will not even see the kingdom."

Nicodemus took a totally natural view:

How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born?

Jesus answered his question:

Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.

That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.

The first birth is natural. That which is born of flesh is flesh. That was your first birth: flesh producing flesh. But that which is born of Spirit is born from above.

I love it when He goes through the bloodline. Jesus made strong statements about calling no man on earth your father and calling no man teacher. You have one Teacher, Jesus Christ, and if the Holy Spirit is not revealing Him, no matter what you call yourself, you are not teaching. He said we have one Father.

When Scripture goes down through the bloodline, it says Joseph was the supposed father of Jesus. In the natural, the whole point of redemption was the virgin birth. Joseph did not touch Mary. Yet the bloodline runs from Adam all the way down to Joseph, and Joseph was called the father of Jesus. He never touched Mary.

Being born of flesh is the Adamic birth: flesh producing flesh. But Jesus was telling Nicodemus, just like Jesus' own birth from Mary was not by Joseph, your birth must be from above.

Hallelujah. Who becomes my Father?

Yes, I honor my father on this earth. He produced the birth of flesh. That is when I was born of water through the birth canal, and when my spirit came into existence. Yes, I am glad I exist. But that birth was flesh from a fallen race.

Now you have to be born from above. Jesus said, "Call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven," and you are all brethren.

Twice [unclear] said, "My wife, my sister." Hallelujah.

Nicodemus had no idea what Jesus was talking about. Jesus was speaking mysteries. Nevertheless, the day would come when you and I would have the nature to understand what He was talking about, and that is exactly what we are doing.

Look at the end of John 3. Verse 33 says:

He that hath received his testimony hath set to his seal that God is true.

For he whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God: for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him.

This is the way most of us preached this, but you have to take it out of context to do it. We say, "He speaks the words of God because God gave Him the Spirit without measure."

Then we teach, "You cannot do the works Jesus did."

"Why not, learned one?"

"Because He had the Spirit without measure."

What are you saying, that we have Him with measure? "Yes, you have Him with measure, so you cannot do the works Jesus did, because He had the Spirit without measure."

Being a teacher, I took that further. In my day, in Romans 12, Paul was speaking out of his apostleship and said God has dealt to every man the measure of faith. The measure He gave him was the measure needed to fulfill the grace God separated him to. In Paul's case, it was his apostolic call.

Paul said, in effect, "I speak by the grace given to me to every man among you not to think more highly of himself than he ought to think, because you did not call yourself. You did not place yourself as an apostle, or in diversities of tongues, or in governments. So why are you thinking of yourself more highly than you are? This grace came from God. You did not earn it, merit it, or call yourself. Think soberly according to the standard that God has dealt to every man the measure of faith."

We know that a measure is part of a whole. What really irritated me when I learned fractions was that my number got bigger but my piece of pie got smaller. "Good, I get one sixty-fourth."

A measure is part of a whole. One third is a measure of three thirds, which makes the whole.

He gave us the measure of faith to fulfill the grace we are called to. What is the grace we are called to? It is the calling you have in the Body of Christ, whether apostle, prophet, teacher, pastor, evangelist, the mighty helps ministry, governments, or diversities of the prayer, the supernaturally empowered prayers of the Spirit, divers tongues.

He gave you not only the grace to fulfill your calling; He gave you the measure of faith you need to walk it out. When you stand before Him and say, "I did not have what I needed," He will say, "I gave you the grace and I gave you the measure to fulfill it. I am basing your reward on it, so do not stand here and tell Me I did not equip you. You are the one who turned the equipment down."

The measure of faith He gave was for you to fulfill the grace of your calling. You will find all that in Romans 12.

When John says Jesus received the Spirit without measure, I linked that together with my lightning-quick mind and said, "Aha. We fulfill a measure of the calling in the Body of Christ. Whatever my call is, I have the grace for the calling and the measure of faith that goes with my calling. Jesus was given the Holy Spirit without measure, and we were given Him with measure because we only have a portion of what we fulfill in the Body. All the members working together, the hand, foot, eye, and nose, make one whole, a devil-stomping, mountain-moving body called the Body of Christ."

Hallelujah.

One day I woke up and my ear was prophesying against my eyes. "I am tired of being this part of the Body of Christ. When was the last time your wife or sweetheart peered intently into your ear and said, 'I love you'?"

The ear prophesied against the eye: "I do not get any glory. The eyes have their whole language. They ask, 'Do you want to go have ice cream?' and they say no, but you know they mean yes. What do you do with me? Hide me under your hair. And when the women cut their hair shorter, they hang things on me and punch holes in me. At least with the eyes, all they do is paint around them to bring them out."

Then my foot was prophesying against my hands: "I do not like it. Thirty-second toenail inspections, shoved into a sock all day long, complained about. And what do the hands get? They even get to help teach. What do I get to do? Hardly anything. Do you ever give me credit? No, and I carry the weight of this ministry."

But that is not what Jesus was talking about in John 3.

On the Born-Again Trail, when John said He speaks the words of God because He received the Spirit without measure, what was the reference?

The Old Testament saints had Him in measure. He could only come upon them and move through them by prophecy, resting upon them for the purposes, pursuits, and plans of God. Then He had to go back where He came from. All He could do was rest upon them for the purposes and plans of God.

But not Jesus. He received Him without measure. Why? Because He was the first Man to be born on this planet spiritually alive in four thousand years. The Holy Ghost did not have to come on Him and then depart. He stepped inside Him, just as He stepped inside you when you were born again.

That is the measure John was talking about.

When Moses said, "I will see God," God put him under the shadow, which is the cleft in the rock. What was that rock a type of? Jesus.

Moses said, "I will see God." God said, "This is the best I can do," and stuck him in the shadow, in the type, the rock. When God passed by, He had to cover Moses because Moses could not see His glory in his state. So God covered him and passed by.

But when you said, "I will see God," He did not put you in the shadow. He put you into Christ Himself. You were born again. When God came by, He did not pass by. He stopped and stepped into you.

Jesus said, "My glory I give unto you."

He stepped in because you have a new nature, and you received the Spirit without measure. Jesus said, "The works that I do shall you do also," because you have Him without measure.

Some things belong to God, and the Holy Spirit has to reveal to you who you are in order for you to do them. He has come to guide you into all truth. He receives of Mine and shows it unto you. All the Father has is Mine, Jesus said, in My glorified humanity. He will take all that I inherited from Him and show it to you, because it is your inheritance too.

Do you not think it is good to be instant in season and out? That means I can step into worship in half a second. Satan had me thinking I was losing the war. My foot.

Amen. Hallelujah, Jesus.

As we graduate to John 4, begin with verse 13. Jesus was talking to the Samaritan woman at the well:

Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again:

But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst.

There is no "again." He shall never thirst.

But the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life.

There is a big difference. The Holy Ghost is a river. Your born-again human spirit is a well. Jesus said you will never thirst because this will spring up into everlasting life, an unending well that will never go dry. It will feed you and quench you. There will never be another thirst when you tap into this well and learn how to operate out of that place.

The Samaritan woman, brilliant as she was, said in verse 15:

Sir, give me this water, that I thirst not, neither come hither to draw.

Jesus said to her:

Go, call thy husband, and come hither.

The woman answered, "I have no husband."

Jesus said, in effect, "You spoke well. You have had five husbands, and the one you have now is not your husband. In that you said truly."

Then comes the woman's brilliance:

Sir, I perceive that thou art a prophet.

What a lightning-quick mind.

Here is something interesting. Jesus recognized the five husbands she had. He also recognized the fact that she was just living with the one she had now. Either those husbands had died, or something else had happened. If they had all died, and she had married another and he died, married another and he died, He probably would have been saying, "You spoke rightly. You are a poisonous murderer, and the one you have now is not your husband."

But He did not. It is interesting that He recognized them all.

The conversation comes around to verse 22, where He says:

Ye worship ye know not what: we know what we worship: for salvation is of the Jews.

The revelation of God was revealed to the Jews, and therefore salvation came through them.

But that is all right, Samaritan. The hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth, for the Father seeketh such to worship Him.

God is a Spirit. He wants to open your well. He seeketh such to worship Him.

Again, I reaffirm and establish the fact that Jesus is talking about a positional truth. You have to register this if you are going to succeed in the kind of worship that changes the anointing you walk in, the presence of God in your life, your circumstances, and especially your testings and trials.

You have to recognize that He is speaking of a positional truth. God is a Spirit, and He seeketh such to worship Him in spirit, little s, and in truth.

The Old Testament saints could not give this to Him. You can. You have a new nature. They did not. They were saved while waiting for the promise. You have received the promise. They were saved because of the new nature that would come from it.

They could not give Him what He desired on the level of fellowship with Him as a Spirit. You can. You have been born again and have the capacity to love with His love out of your new nature. You can give Him the fellowship He waited for from the fall of the human race to that point: four thousand years. It has been six thousand now.

The church has not done a very good job through entire centuries when darkness took back over, of giving Him what He has desired.

If you notice now, as things are winding down, God is getting through to more and more people. More and more of them are having experiences to do with worship. God is catching people up into heaven and showing them things that astound us when they take a parable and compare it to something once so hidden.

When I first came in the eighties and held a revival at a church in this town, I slipped into the Spirit and saw people actually leaving here, going to heaven, getting refreshed, and coming back after visiting God. It was frequent. When that began to happen, I knew we were getting closer and closer. I prophesied it, and if they kept a file of the tapes, you could find the tape it was on.

I knew that when that began to happen more and more frequently, the end would be closer and closer. I believe that was something like sixteen or seventeen years ago now. So we are getting closer and closer.

The Father seeketh such to worship Him. He has looked for this level of fellowship. If you will not let the flesh stop you, He will not let it stop Him.

The progression I wanted to take you into was Matthew, Hebrews, and Psalms, and to establish even more strongly this positional truth: the Old Testament saints had Him in measure. You do not, because you have been born again. The Holy Spirit has stepped into you, and all that He is is there without measure.

He is even willing to teach you exactly what the Father wants in the areas of worship. He has certainly been charged with taking the position in the Godhead of revealing Jesus unto you in all that He is.

The Old Testament saints could not give Him this kind of fellowship that He sought after. You can. I will affirm again, as we prove chapter after chapter, that this is a positional truth.

Why is this so important? Because before I understood this with all my heart, I tended to abort worship. I tended to be turned back from it because there was no accurate information that would keep me in private worship long enough for anything to happen to me that God desired to happen.

God had to come and visit me Himself in this auditorium about three years ago. I was standing right here, and He slew me under the power. The wind of the Holy Spirit blew over me. I did not know if my spirit was going up or if I was still lying there.

All I know is that He began to talk to me very loudly and said, "You do not know anything about worship."

I thought I did. The most I had probably ever worshiped was about an hour. Most of my time in the closet had been spent praying in tongues, and that is where the revelation came from.

He said to me, "Son..." I was on the ninth day of a fast.

So I said, "I am fasting, though."

The little I did know about worship was that it was supposed to be out of intelligible language, because I am offering my soul first. My soul is the part of me I communicate with you through. With my natural man I contact physical things. With my soul, mind, will, intellect, and emotions, I make contact with my fellow man through accumulated knowledge, emotions, feelings, and information. We make contact through soul.

Jesus revealed that God is Spirit. Those who worship Him must worship Him in spirit. You contact God with your spirit.

So when He said to worship Him in spirit and in truth, my question was, "Where do I start?" I started with intelligible language, the language I communicate with you in, trying to express to Him and offer myself.

Finally, in the learning process, I heard myself praying by direction of the Holy Spirit: "Holy Spirit, is it not Your ministry to reveal Jesus in me? Teach me how to offer myself in worship. That is Your job. You had better teach me."

He did.

Not only did He teach me, He showed me the areas where I was weak. I was weak in them because there was not adequate Word to cover my faith in those areas. Uncertainty would follow: "Are the hours in this closet really going to make any difference? Will telling Him as best I know how, offering my soul up, saying I love Him, worship Him, and glorify Him over and over, really do anything?"

What was going to cover that? I would have aborted the closet many times had He not slain me out and said, "I want you to pray this amount of hours a day."

He had the right to do that to me, because in the mysteries I had prayed my way in the Holy Ghost into those areas. The Holy Ghost had every right to take my stupidity and bring it under subjection to the mysteries of Christ, because I had prayed them out in tongues.

I was lying on the floor on the ninth day of a fast. He said, "I did not tell you not to fast. But fasting cannot give you what worship can. Neither can worship give you what fasting can."

Then He said to me, "Men will put all their confidence in just one key. One will teach only this, another will teach only that, and people will say that is how they bring perfection to the whole Body. But because they put their confidence in just one key, they will not let Me reveal everything Jesus is. Because they put all their confidence in a single key, they do not have the benefit of the other major keys I have."

Immediately I felt guilty. I said, "I put all my confidence in praying in tongues."

He said, "Fortunately, you put it into the one that is the revelation gift and has given you the other keys you are enjoying the victory of."

Praying in tongues is not the whole gospel. The Born-Again Trail is. Praying in tongues is just a limb. But I was a limb first. I must have been one of those limbs you stick in the ground and it grows its own root system, because He put the tree on it.

I strengthened that positional truth again by getting the best books I could find and the best information on worship from influential people. I like to check and see what people are saying about things, so I look to see what primary leaders in the church are doing and saying.

It is not because I claim to know everything or have all the answers. However He has put His hand on me, I do know this: He has called all of us to walk in the fullness of His Word. I know I have that right.

I cannot help it. I do not do it deliberately, but when I sit in a service, I take the whole service in. I do not just take in what is being said, but the spirit that is there, what is being said, how people are affected, and the atmosphere of the whole service. I can encompass the whole thing in seconds.

When you introduce a friend to me, I never hear their name. I am always searching and listening. I want to know beforehand what they are going to do.

So I got some of the most popular teaching and found that everybody who addressed "in spirit" was searching for some hidden meaning. When they read "worship Him in spirit and in truth," they were always searching for a hidden meaning.

One of the most influential men teaching on worship gave an example. He got into the Spirit and worshiped God one day, and it was glorious. He could not wait to repeat the performance the next day. So he went in and kept trying to get into the Spirit and worship Him.

He said, "God, what did I do wrong?"

He could not get into that presence all day. Then the next day, spontaneously, in the car, he threw his hands up, and God came and visited him. His conclusion was that he had tried to attain it by works, and it is totally by grace. The day before, he had tried by works to break in and could not.

So he explained the whole thing that way, and the whole day was wasted because he could not get into the Spirit.

That is why I like little David Hogan. He is definitely not shoveling diamonds out in the service; he is shoveling pure coal. But they keep turning into diamonds after people get past the lumps.

When he started talking about worship, he made one statement that let me know he understood it. They are walking through the jungle, a company of people, walking the paths and finding tribes. Witch doctors are hanging out on the paths and in the trees, and while they are walking along, they are worshipping God out loud.

By the statement he made, I knew he did not always feel God while worshipping Him. He said, "My job is to worship Him. His job is to receive it."

I knew what he was saying. Feelings have nothing to do with it.

Well, they do not, but they do.

They do not because they are not your signal whether He is receiving your worship. When you have a thick lump of flesh between you and Him and you are sacrificing worship, heaven is shouting.

But feelings do matter in this sense: the day your spirit gets so full that your sense man can feel Him all the time, that is a real place. How are you going to get there until you deal with the lump of coal?